

FORGE Phase 1 · Week 9 · Session 26 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 26: Decision Making Under Pressure" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 26 as written runs about 110 minutes. This insert adds two short videos, which play inside the segments they serve, and one four-minute TED-Ed lesson, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 26A, "Decision Making Under Pressure"** (2 min 9 s). Why six steps are not always possible, what stress does to the brain (the prefrontal cortex goes quiet, the amygdala takes over), tunnel vision and the four defaults (fight, flex, shut down, run), and today's tools. It ends on "When the pressure hits, where does your body take you?" and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 26B, "The 10-10-10 Rule"** (1 min 48 s). The three questions, then the guide's two examples side by side (throwing the punch and walking away) at 10 minutes, 10 months and 10 years. It ends on the quick-practice prompt and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **A short lesson:** Madhumita Murgia, *How stress affects your brain* (TED-Ed, 4 minutes), with discussion questions.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening Circle	10	As written, with the consequence homework check.
0:10	Video 26A , then Review and Reflection	10	Play it straight after the check-in. It gives the tunnel-vision science in the guide's words and ends on the question of each man's default. Take four or five answers. Nobody has to defend his default.
0:20	TED-Ed lesson: <i>How stress affects your brain</i> , and discussion	9	Four minutes of video, five of discussion (questions below). Introduce it in one sentence: "You just heard what stress does in the moment. This shows what it does when it never lets up, and what helps."
0:29	Instruction: Pre-Deciding	20	As written.
0:49	Instruction: Personal Rules	15	As written, with the 5-minute discussion.
1:04	Video 26B , then Instruction: The 10-10-10 Rule	10	The video teaches the rule with the guide's examples, so skip the monologue. It ends on the quick-practice prompt; go straight into the pairs.
1:14	Practice Exercise: Pressure Decision Scenarios	30	As written.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
1:44	Writing Exercise: Your 5 Personal Rules	10	As written.
1:54	Closing Circle	5	As written, with the homework.
1:59	Buffer	1	

Discussion questions for *How stress affects your brain*

1. The lesson says stress that never lets up ramps up the amygdala, the brain's fear center, and wears down the prefrontal cortex, the part that handles decision-making and judgment. Where have you seen that happen, in yourself or in the dorm?
2. It separates a short burst of stress from stress that never lets up. Which kind do you live with in here? What does it do to your decisions?
3. Stress makes everything feel urgent. What is one thing this week that felt urgent but was not actually important?
4. It ends on what helps: exercise, and meditation with deep breathing. What do you already do to calm down before you decide something? What could you add this week?

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *How stress affects your brain* — **YouTube** (TED-Ed): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WuyPuH9ojCE> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/madhumita_murgia_how_stress_affects_your_brain

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Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 26A and 26B and the TED-Ed lesson loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Lesson previewed and cleared under the facility's media rules